Very firm speech by Blinken against the expansion of Israeli settlements and the destruction of Palestinian homes, to a meeting of the American Israel Public Affairs Committee (AIPAC, a pro-Israel lobbying group). But the present Israeli government speeches do not help. A two-state solution is still the American official goal; it is the only rational one, but is less and less within reach.

Today the Likud is supposed to vote on whether it will enable the opposition to nominate one of the candidates to the Judicial Selection Committee. If Netanyahu wants to reach a compromise in the negotiations at the President's Residence, he will have to make sure that the vote of the Likud goes the right way.

Tuesday, June 6

Levin agrees that the coalition will have only one representative in the Judicial Selection Committee. Was it the result of a nudge from Netanyahu?

Yesterday Netanyahu agreed take upon himself the chairmanship of a committee set up to deal with crime in the Arab community in Israel. Since the beginning of the year some ninety cases of murder have been registered. The police, if it intervenes at all, has been totally overwhelmed. It seems to be the "work" of four major gangs. If they are so well known, why has none of their bosses been arrested? Because they are Arabs? Because as the chief of police, Shabtai, once famously said to Ben-Gvir: They are used to murdering each other? As I mentioned previously, Israel's Arab citizens were considered as second-class citizens at the outset. In the meantime, much has changed: they enroll in universities, they work in all walks of life, they have four parties in the Knesset, they are about 2 million now, out of 10 million; there are even intermarriages with Israeli Jews, and yet they harbor not-so-hidden grudges against the Jewish community, although they